Adam Bawatneh

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Website | GitHub | LinkedIn

Research Interests

Social reasoning and Theory of Mind, mental-state representations, and how AI systems use social context.
Interested in exploring these questions across language and multimodal settings, including generative AI and agent systems.
Current work: social reasoning in simulated societies.

Education

University of Central Florida — Orlando, Florida
Ph.D. in Computer Science — Aug 2025 – May 2029 (expected); GPA: 4.00/4.00
University of Central Florida — Orlando, Florida
B.S. in Computer Science — Aug 2022 – May 2025; GPA: 4.00/4.00

Selected Publication

Adam Bawatneh[*], Sagar Sapkota, Amrit Singh Bedi, Santu Karmaker, and Mubarak Shah.
"OmniToM: Benchmarking Theory of Mind in LLMs via Explicit Belief Modeling."
NeurIPS 2026, Evaluations & Datasets Track. Project page

Experience

Graduate Research Assistant, University of Central Florida — May 2026 – Present
Conduct AI research and contribute to government proposal development, including IARPA-focused proposals; serve as PI for an NSF ACCESS allocation; prepare weekly research updates and deliverables; give lightning talks to visiting researchers and industry guests; reviewer: NeurIPS, AAAI, ACL, WWW.

AI Intern, The Good Samaritan Institute — Jan 2024 – Apr 2024
Explored business applications of GPT and other AI tools; used Zapier and Google Cloud for workflow integrations and discussed AI data-center projects.

Undergraduate Teaching Assistant, University of Central Florida — May 2023 – May 2025
Led labs and mentored students in C, Python, and Java courses serving more than 1,500 students.

Selected Research Projects

OmniToM: Social Reasoning Evaluation for LLMs — Oct 2025 – Present

- Evaluated mental-state representations in social-reasoning scenarios.
- Evaluated commercial and open models; coordinated 11 annotators and 1.1K+ review hours.

CADS: Context-Aware Detection of Specialized Language — Summer 2026 – Present
Mentored an REU student on a project that continues in the lab.

- Developed and evaluated an NLP pipeline to identify specialized language in context.
- Assessed how the approach transfers across domains and languages.

BIAS-101: Demographic Bias in Video Action Recognition — Jan 2025 – Apr 2025
Audited demographic representation in video data, screening 85,000+ videos and curating 2,000+ clips.

DETECT: Real-Time Gaze and Facial-Signal Analysis — Aug 2024 – Apr 2025
Led a 6-member team building and deploying a real-time gaze and facial-signal system.

Rate My Peer: Academic Peer Review System — Jun 2024 – Jul 2024
Built a faculty-sponsored peer-review system for team projects with an 8-member team.

Technical Skills

Research: Social reasoning, Theory of Mind, research design, benchmarking, experimental analysis
AI: Natural language processing, machine learning, language models, model evaluation, responsible AI
Programming: Python, C/C++, Java, JavaScript, Go, SQL
Model Platforms: Azure OpenAI, Anthropic API, Google Vertex AI, Hugging Face
Cloud and HPC: Microsoft Azure, Google Cloud, NSF ACCESS
Tools: Git/GitHub, Linux, Docker, PostgreSQL, REST APIs, LaTeX